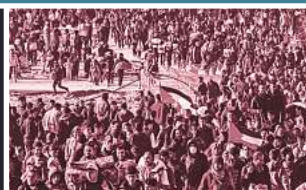


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KILLING ME SOFTLY
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Secret to health
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UAE Food Bank gives global aid to 28.9 million

DUBAI
BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Senior Assistant Editor

The UAE Food Bank (EFB) has revealed that its food aid initiatives reached 28.9 million beneficiaries around the world in 2024, recording a 55 per cent increase compared to 2023.

The EFB, one of the global initiatives promoted by His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, released its annual data for 2024 yesterday.

The organisation also made significant progress in its environmental sustainability goals, successfully diverting 5,466 tonnes of food from landfill. This initiative contributed to reducing environmental pollution and emissions associated with food waste, supporting the UAE's target of reducing food waste by 30 per cent by 2027. By ensuring surplus food is redistributed effectively, the UAE Food Bank continues to promote responsible food management practices that align with global sustainability objectives.

The Bank continued to strengthen its global partnerships through 30 strategic agreements and memoranda of understanding with various global entities.

UAE's \$40b investment set to strengthen ties with Italy

PRESIDENT, ITALIAN PM DISCUSS WAYS TO IMPROVE STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP

ROME

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and Giorgia Meloni, Prime Minister of Italy, yesterday discussed cooperation between the UAE and Italy as part of the strategic partnership between the two countries.

Their talks followed the UAE's announcement of a \$40 billion investment in key sectors of Italy's economy as the two countries strengthen ties.

Shaikh Mohammad and Meloni later witnessed the exchange of agreements and memoranda of understanding covering various sectors, including industry, advanced technology, artificial intelligence, energy, health, culture, education, scientific research, defence, transportation, space, mining, and economic partnerships with African countries. These agreements are expected to further enhance UAE-Italy relations.

40 agreements signed

More than 40 new agreements were signed in total, thus starting the implementation of common goals and reaffirming the joint commitment to enhancing strategic cooperation.

Shaikh Mohammad also conferred the Order of the Union on Meloni in recognition of



Courtesy: UAE Presidential Court

■ Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed and Giorgia Meloni at Quirinal Palace in Rome yesterday. They witnessed the exchange of agreements and memoranda of understanding.

her role in strengthening the deep-rooted ties between the UAE and Italy.

Meloni expressed her appreciation to Shaikh Mohammad for the honour, underscoring the close relationship between the two nations.

The President noted that UAE-Italy relations date back to the first year of the UAE's

founding as a nation and have grown over the years into a strategic partnership. He affirmed the UAE's commitment to achieving the aims of this partnership and elevating it to the level of a comprehensive strategic partnership to serve the interests of both nations and their peoples.

Shaikh Mohammad stated

that non-oil trade volume between the two countries reached \$14.1 billion in 2024, marking a 21.2 per cent increase compared to 2023. He emphasised that through enhanced cooperation, trade exchange between the two nations is expected to continue growing.

— WAM

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BUSINESS

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as UAE car
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after tanks
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WORLD

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tell workers to
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AI platform to ease visa services

Salama offers a quick, seamless way for users to manage residency tasks

DUBAI
BY AGHADDIR ALI
Senior Reporter

The General Directorate of Residency and Foreigners Affairs (GDRFA) in Dubai has unveiled a groundbreaking new artificial intelligence platform, Salama, aimed at transforming the efficiency of government services. The Salama platform is designed to simplify residency services, offering a quick and seamless way for users to manage residency tasks.

Through the platform, users can complete transactions, make payments, and perform

Salama allows users to renew or cancel residency permits, receive quick responses to visa inquiries, and complete transactions without navigating multiple systems or visiting service centres.

other residency-related actions without the need for traditional forms or paperwork.

Among its features, Salama allows users to renew or cancel residency permits, receive quick responses to visa inquiries, and complete transactions without navigating multiple systems or visiting service centres. Lieutenant

General Mohammad Ahmad Al Marri, Director General of GDRFA Dubai stressed that Salama is a testament to the GDRFA's commitment to leveraging advanced technologies to improve the quality of life in Dubai.

Individuals can avail now

Colonel Khalid Bin Madia Al Falasi, Assistant Director General of the Digital Services Affairs Sector at GDRFA Dubai, told *Gulf News* that the new service is currently available for individuals, primarily to renew or cancel residency permits. In the next phase, it will be extended to include companies. Colonel Al Falasi said the service is offered in more than 40 languages and more will be added. He said each transaction takes only 10-20 seconds.

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